UNIT 6

CONSUMER PROTECTION

18 CHAPTER

GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL MECHANISM

பிணியின்மை செல்வம் விளைவின்பம் ஏமம்
அணியென்ப நாட்டிவ் வைந்து.

–குறள் 738

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Freedom from epidemics, wealth, produce, happiness and protection (to subjects); these five, the learned, say, are the ornaments of a kingdom.

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Learning Objectives

To enable the students to understand the

- Grievance Redressal Mechanism
- Three Tier Consumer Councils
- Voluntary Consumer Organisations

Chapter Synopsis

18.01 Grievance and Need for Redressal Mechanism
18.02 Consumer Councils
18.03 Three Tier Courts or Quasi Judiciary
18.04 District Forum
18-05 State Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission or State Commission
18-06 National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission (NCDRC) or National Commission
18.07 Voluntary Organizations for Consumer Awareness

18.01 Grievance and Redressal Mechanism

Exploitation is common where consumers are unaware of their rights and privileges. In this modern world, Consumers are the vital part of the business. They decide the success or otherwise of the business. However they are exploited by the sellers in many ways because, they are not aware of the products and services available. Government has also taken necessary steps to save the Consumers. It is in this context grievance redressal mechanism becomes important. This chapter is an attempt to explain grievance redressal mechanism followed in India.

Mahatma Gandhi said about the Customer

"A customer is the most important visitor on our premises. He is not dependent on us. We are dependent on him. He is not an interruption of our work. He is the purpose of it. He is not an outsider of our business. He is part of it. We are not doing him a favour by serving him. He is doing us a favour by giving us the opportunity to do so."

Under the modern philosophy of marketing, consumer is supposed to be the king and business is expected to provide maximum possible satisfaction to consumers. But in reality, consumers are often exploited. In

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